MIRACLE ON DICE

Mobile App Guide

Tips, tricks, and a tour of the phone app

This is not the rulebook. It will not teach you the rules from scratch — it teaches you the app. Where a rule matters to explain a screen, it is referenced so you know why the app behaves the way it does.

v2.4 • companion to Rulebook v3.2

Companion to the Miracle on Dice Rulebook.

1 • Getting the app on your phone

The mobile app is a home-screen web app. There is no app store, no download fee, no review queue — just your browser and a link.

Install it

1. Open the app link in Chrome (Android) or Safari (iPhone).
2. Android: tap the browser menu → “Install app” or “Add to Home screen”. iPhone: tap Share → “Add to Home Screen”.
3. Launch it from the new home-screen icon. It opens full-screen, like a native app.

One account, every screen

- The phone app uses the same online database as the desktop game, so a room code started on your phone can be joined from a computer — and vice versa. Phone-vs-computer cross-play works.
- Portrait mode is the intended way to play. Landscape shrinks the board so far the dice stop being tappable.

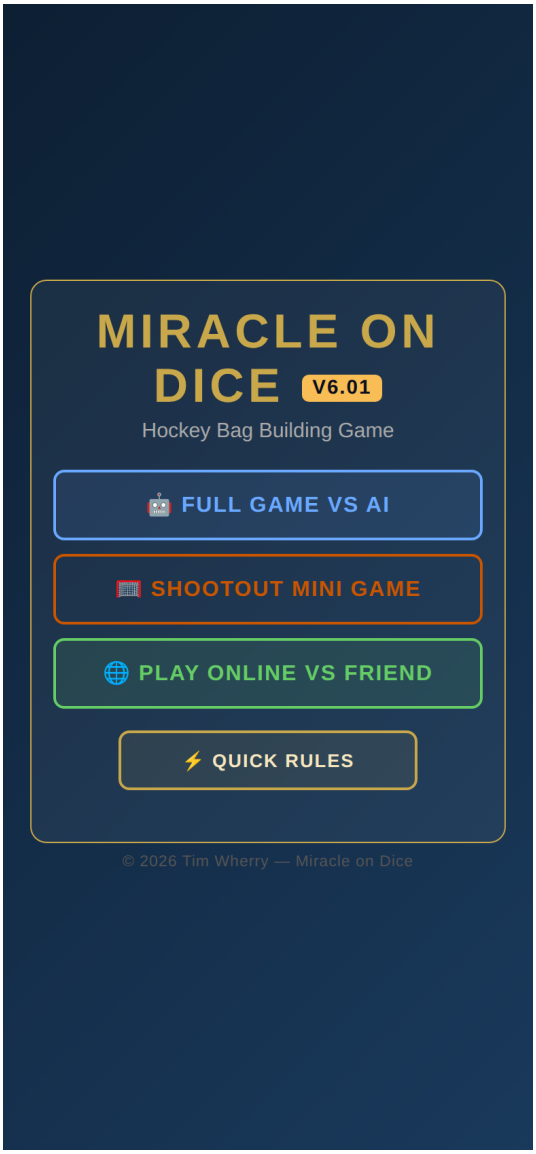
VERSION BADGE

After an update, the app can look “stuck” on the old version for a while. The version badge (top of the welcome screen and in the game header) is the source of truth — if it does not show the new number, you are not running the new file yet. See §14 Troubleshooting.

2 • Starting a game

The welcome screen offers three ways to play:

- Vs AI — you against AI Chuck, the built-in opponent (see §8).
- Online — play a friend over the internet with a room code. One player hosts, the other joins with the code.

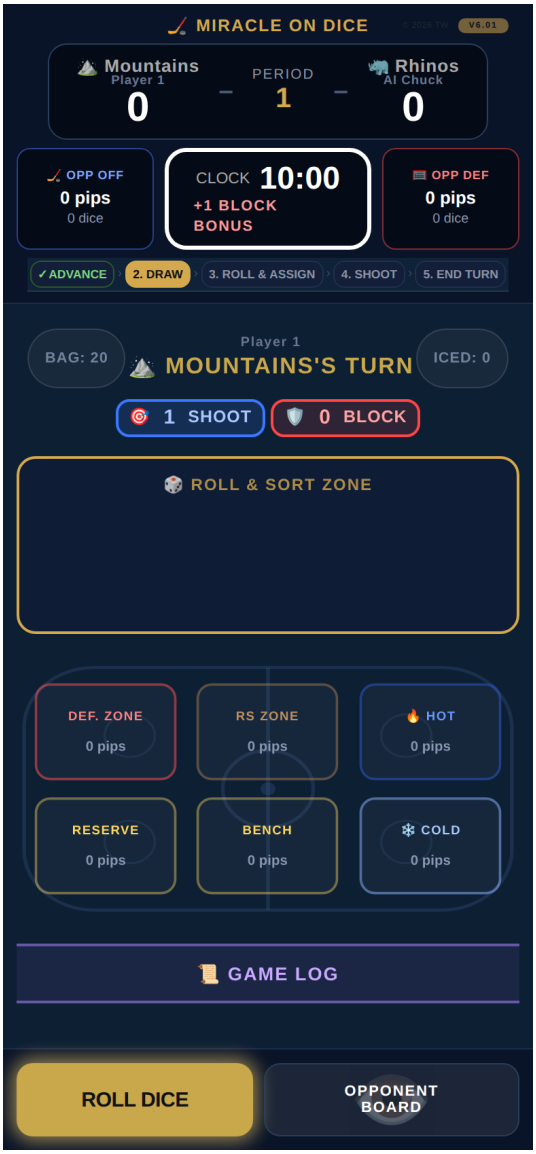


The welcome screen (v6.06)

AUTOSAVE

Solo and Vs AI games autosave to your phone automatically. If you leave mid-game, the welcome screen offers Resume — showing the mode, period, and clock — or a small Discard link if you would rather start fresh. Starting a new game clears the old save, and finished games clean up after themselves.

3 • Your screen, top to bottom



The main board: scoreboard, clock, Roll & Sort Zone, and mini zone grid

Everything is stacked vertically so your thumb never has to travel far. From the top:

- Title bar with the version badge at the far right — your proof of which build is running.
- Scoreboard: team emoji + team name, a small faded who-label underneath (Player 1, AI Chuck, or the player's name), goals, and the period.
- Clock with opponent summaries on either side: opponent offense (left) and defense (right), each showing live pips and dice counts.
- Phase stepper: Advance › Draw › Roll & Assign › Shoot › End Turn, with your current step highlighted.
- Turn header: BAG and ICED pill counts on either side of whose turn it is, with a small who-label above the team name. Tap either pill — BAG shows the count, ICED opens a card with your iced dice. Below that, your Shoot, energy, and Block token counts.
- The stage: the big card in the middle always shows one zone — the active one. It starts on Roll & Sort and stays put even when empty.

- Mini zone grid: six tappable zone cards below the stage (Defensive, Roll & Sort, Hot, Reserve, Bench, Cold), framed by a faded hockey rink outline. Each shows dots for its dice (color-coded by position) and a live pip count. Tap any mini to bring that zone up to the stage — no popups, the zone itself moves. The stage snaps back to Roll & Sort at the start of every turn, yours or the opponent's. If dice are sitting in Roll & Sort, its mini pulses gold — a nudge that work remains.
- Bottom action bar: the buttons for whatever phase you are in, always within thumb reach — the text size adjusts to how many buttons are showing. The OPP button (a faded ◉ behind "OPPONENT BOARD") opens the opponent's board (§9). END TURN is always at the far right. While watching the opponent's turn, the actions bar takes two-thirds and OPP takes one-third.
- Game log: a running transcript of everything that happened, newest at the bottom.

STAGE + MINIS

The stage is your focus, the minis are your map. Glance at the dots and pips to see where everything sits, then tap a mini to work in that zone. Your opponent never sees which zone you have on stage — it is purely your own view.

4 • Playing a turn

A turn follows the stepper. Five steps, ten minutes on the clock, five turns apiece per period:

1. Advance — move dice one zone up the ice (Cold → Hot). Some advances cost energy.
2. Draw — draw 6 fresh dice into Roll & Sort.
3. Roll & Assign — roll, then tap a die to open its choices as big buttons in a bottom sheet. The choice buttons are color-coded to their zone: blue offense, red defense, green fight, gold reserve, black iced. Send keepers to Hot, Cold, or Defensive. You may reroll selected dice before you start assigning — once a die is assigned, rerolls are off the table.
4. Shoot — the combined assign-and-buy phase. Move dice into the Shoot zone, visit the shop, then declare your shot (see §7).
5. End Turn — hand play to the other side.

THE CORE GESTURE

Tapping a die always opens the same bottom sheet with the same big buttons — tap a die, tap a zone. That mental model never changes, wherever the die sits.

BLANK SAFETY NET

If the HC Reroll is still live in Roll & Sort and you tap a blank, the app asks first — "HC Reroll is still available. Ice this blank instead of rerolling it?" A nudge, not a gate: confirm to ice it, cancel to keep it for the reroll.

5 • Dice, zones, and energy

The zones

- Roll & Sort — where drawn and rolled dice land. Your sorting tray.
- Hot — warmed-up dice, one step from the action.
- Cold — dice waiting to be advanced. Cold dice can be advanced to Hot on a later turn.
- Defensive — your blockers. They defend shots and never shoot.

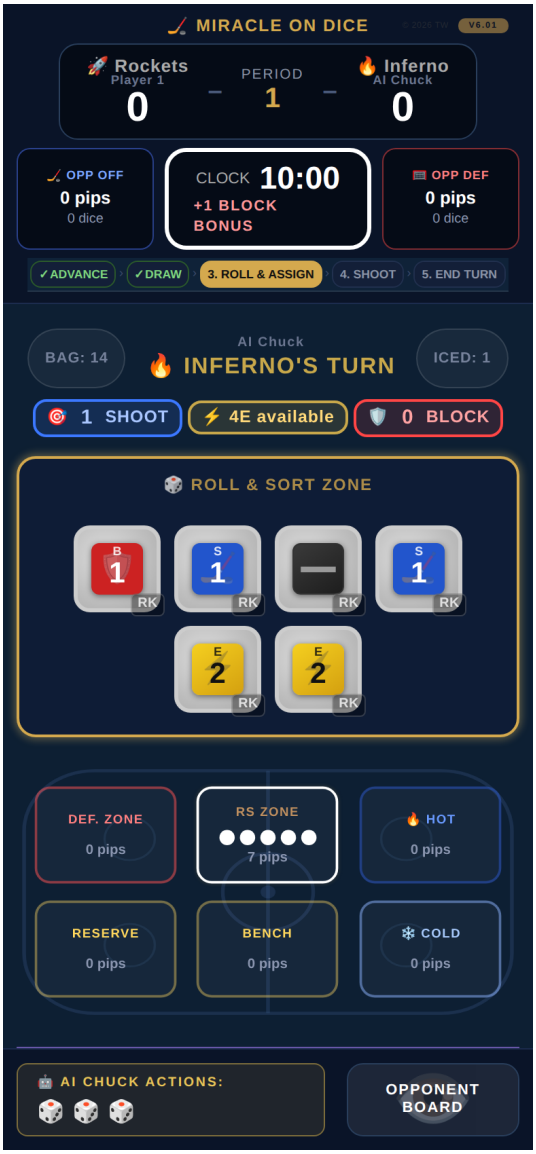
- Reserve — your energy bank (up to 2 dice). Reserve dice count toward shop spending.
- Bench — where the loser of a shot parks up to 2 dice. They return at the start of your next turn.
- Iced — spent dice, out until the period reset.

Energy and the clock

- Energy faces (E) pay for advances and buys. The shop shows your available energy: Roll & Sort energy dice plus Reserve. Change from a purchase spins back down to Roll & Sort.
- The clock border is white from 10:00 to 5:00, then pulses red from 4:00 to 1:00 — the hot zone. Your block bonus grows as the clock drops: +1, then +2, then +3 on the final 1:00 turn.

The Head Coach die

The HC die always renders last in Roll & Sort so it never gets lost in the shuffle. Its faces: 1E, 1E, 2E, Reroll, Reroll, Advance. Its reroll side reads “Spend Reroll → pick any R&S dice to reroll” — the die is spent and disappears, and it always shows its value so there is no guessing what you rolled. The Advance face moves one Cold Zone die to Hot. If the HC die is the only die left in Roll & Sort, it melts away on its own — no need to tap it.



Rolled dice in the Roll & Sort Zone — note the faded symbols behind the pips

DICE FACES

Dice faces carry a faded symbol behind the pip — hockey stick for Shoot, shield for Block, lightning for Energy, star for Wild, fist for Fight, fast-forward for Advance, die for Reroll. The number is big, the letter small, so pips read at a glance.

6 • The shop

Tap Open Shop in the bottom bar during the Shoot phase. (The old standalone Buy button is gone — the bottom bar is the way in.)

- Each of your lineup cards shows its faces and how many copies remain. One price: the tier cost in energy.
- Buying adds a fresh die of that card to your bag AND trashes one iced Rookie forever. No Rookie to trash, no buy.

- The HC card is never for sale — it is automatic.
- Sold-out cards are marked and cannot be bought.

TIP
Bank spare energy dice in the Reserve. They still count as shop energy, they are safe there, and the 2-die Reserve carries your momentum across the period break.

7 • Tokens and the shot

Shoot and Block tokens are the mind-game layer. A few things the app insists on:

- Token steppers show “N available” and grey out at zero — for both the shooter and the blocker.
- The shooter always taps Confirm Shot to lock tokens in. There is no auto-lock, even at zero tokens: declaring nothing is a decision, and the app makes you make it on purpose.
- Tokens persist across periods. No need to burn them before the horn.

The Shot on Goal card

1. Declare: set your Shoot tokens, confirm, and the card opens for the defender.
2. Defend: the defender assigns block dice and Block tokens. The Auto-Assign button pulses to draw the eye, and a gentle pulse nudges the available dice — a reminder, never a gate. Rolling with zero blockers is legal. Selected dice show a bright white halo, as do the attacker’s dice up top.
3. Resolve: both sides roll. Winner takes the goal; the loser chooses.

LAST SHOT
On the 2:00 and 1:00 turns — the last shot of the period — a pulsing “LAST SHOT OF THE PERIOD” banner appears on the Shot on Goal card for both sides, and the defender’s block dice start pre-selected (tap to unselect; tokens stay manual).

BENCH RULE
The loser of a shot picks which of their assigned dice go to the bench (max 2 — the rest ice over). The choice appears even for 1–2 dice, and the other side just sees a brief “choosing…” note. Exception: on your last turn of a period there is no benching — dice go straight to ice and the log says so. Benching with no turns left would be pointless, since benched dice only return at your next turn.

8 • Vs AI Chuck

AI Chuck is the built-in opponent: a virtual hand that taps the same buttons you tap. It cannot cheat — it spends energy and follows the same rules.

- He plays at one steady pace — the menu is just Start Game, no speed choices.
- The “AI CHUCK ACTIONS” bar on the main screen narrates everything he does, step by step.
- While he studies your shot, a slim bar on the Shot on Goal card shows what he is committing — then it gets out of the way the moment the shot resolves.
- Every AI turn ends with a summary card and a Continue button. Missed a beat? It is all there.
- His bench picks are narrated in the actions bar: he benches his best tiers, forwards before defense before goalie.

9 • Scouting the other bench

Tap ◉ OPP in the bottom bar to open the opponent's board: their Shoot and Block tokens up top, then Hot, Cold, Defensive, Bench, and Reserve with live pip counts and dice counts — color-coded to match their zones — then Iced and Bag counts below. Tap any zone for a quick summary of what dice and pips sit there.

> **TIP**
> Before declaring a shot, peek at their Defensive zone and remaining lineup cards. Knowing what blockers they have left turns token declaration from a guess into a read.

10 • Periods, faceoffs, and shootouts

- Faceoff: auto-rolls at the start of each period. The winner takes the even clock turns (10:00, 8:00, 6:00, 4:00, 2:00), a +1 token of their choice — Shoot or Block, and a bonus free reroll on the 10:00 turn: the button reads "Select Dice for Bonus Reroll" with the word Bonus pulsing softly, so you know you are picking dice for the bonus. On Chuck's 10:00 turn the bonus reroll is fully automatic — no button. The other side takes the odds (including the 1:00).
- Period end: the overlay announces it; in online games only the host's "Period N →" button works.
- Tied after regulation? A shootout mini-game decides it — see §12.

12 • Shootout mini-game

When the game is tied after regulation, a shootout decides the winner. A coin flip (with a little coin animation) decides who shoots first.

- Each shooter picks dice to shoot; the goalie defends with block dice.
- Shooter dice are shown large, filling their cards — easy to tap and read.
- The shootout scoreboard shows each team's emoji + name, with a faded who-label underneath.
- Goalies: the SO face's pip value = number of block dice (face type ignored). G3–G6 all carry SO2 (costed).

13 • Phone bits worth knowing

- Back button (Android): inside a game it asks before returning to the menu; on the menu, press twice to exit.
- The old Buy / Lineup / Reset row under the stepper is gone. Open Shop lives in the bottom bar, lineups live on the opponent board view, and a labeled RESET GAME button sits at the far right of the header, next to the centered clock.
- Everything important is reachable without scrolling the page: header on top, actions on the bottom, zones in the middle.

12 • Tips & tricks

- Declare tokens deliberately every single shot. Zero is a legal declaration — the app makes you confirm it because "nothing" should be a choice, not an accident.
- The HC reroll earns its keep when several dice land blank. One bad roll is not worth the die; four are.

- When you lose a shot, bench your best tiers — you choose, so protect your stars. They are back next turn.
- Do not plan around benching on the period's last turn. The app skips it automatically.
- Save a token or two across the period break. They persist, and an early-period +1 can swing a close shot.
- In Vs AI, the summary card at the end of every Chuck turn means you never truly miss anything.
- Cold dice are future offense. If you have nothing worth shooting this turn, advance and bank — the clock bonuses reward patience on defense.
- Watch the clock border. When it goes red, every shot is defended harder — plan your Shoot tokens accordingly.

13 • Words the app uses

- Advance — move a die one zone up the ice.
- Declare — lock in Shoot/Block tokens before a shot.
- Buy — the shop's way to buy a die (tier cost + trash 1 iced Rookie).
- Iced — a die spent for the period.
- Hot zone — the red clock window, 4:00 to 0:00.
- HC — Head Coach die.

14 • Troubleshooting

The app looks the same after an update

1. Check the version badge — top of the welcome screen and in the game header. It is the source of truth.
2. Add ?v=1 (or any new value) to the page address and reload. This bypasses the CDN cache.
3. Wait. The file host can take 5–10+ minutes to serve a new file even after a successful upload.
4. Re-download with a fresh filename and compare the file size against the announced size.

Other hiccups

- Online opponent's moves not appearing? Double-check the room code and the connection — only the host's period-advance button works, by design.
- Lost your place after the phone slept? Solo and Vs AI games resume from the welcome screen.
- A button does nothing? Read the toast — most "dead" buttons are the app enforcing turn order (e.g. shopping before the Shoot phase).

That is the whole tour — for now. As the app gains tricks, so will these pages.